

Ideation Phase — Define the Problem Statements

Date	4 August 2026
Project Name	Online Complaint Registration System (MERN Stack)
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Purpose of This Exercise

A well-articulated customer problem statement allows the team to find the ideal solution for the challenges real users face. By stepping into the shoes of each stakeholder — citizen, officer, and administrator — the team can empathize with their goals, frustrations, and emotions, ensuring the Online Complaint Registration platform is built around genuine user needs rather than assumptions.

Stakeholders Considered

The Online Complaint Registration platform serves three distinct user types, each with different goals and pain points:

- **Citizen:** seeks a fast, transparent way to file and track complaints.
- **Officer/Staff:** needs an organized way to manage and resolve assigned complaints.
- **Admin:** responsible for overseeing departments and ensuring accountability.

Customer Problem Statements

Three problem statements were defined, one for each primary stakeholder, using the 'I am / I'm trying to / But / Because / Which makes me feel' framework.

Problem Statement – PS-1 (Citizen)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
A resident dealing with a civic/service issue	File a complaint and track its resolution status easily	I don't know who to contact or whether my complaint was received	There is no centralized digital system to log and track complaints	Frustrated & Ignored

Problem Statement – PS-2 (Officer)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
A department officer handling public complaints	Manage and resolve assigned complaints efficiently	Complaints arrive via scattered channels (calls, paper, email) with no central log	There is no digital system to assign, prioritize, and track complaint resolution	Overwhelmed & Disorganized

Problem Statement – PS-3 (Admin)

I am	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
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A platform administrator overseeing complaint handling	Monitor complaint resolution across departments and ensure accountability	I have no dashboard to view overall status, delays, or officer performance	Complaint data is scattered across departments with no unified reporting	Inefficient & Unsure
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Problem Statement Table

PS	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A resident dealing with a civic issue	Book/file a complaint quickly	Don't know who to contact	No single platform for tracking	Frustrated & Ignored
PS-2	A department officer	Manage complaints efficiently	Scattered channels, no central log	No digital assignment system	Overwhelmed & Disorganized
PS-3	A platform administrator	Monitor resolution & accountability	No central dashboard	Manual, scattered reporting	Inefficient & Unsure

Impact if Left Unsolved

- **Citizens:** lose trust in public service responsiveness and stop reporting issues.
- **Officers:** get buried under untracked backlogs and miss resolution deadlines.
- **Admins:** cannot ensure accountability or measure department performance, risking public trust.

How These Statements Guide the Solution

Each problem statement directly maps to a core feature of the Online Complaint Registration platform: PS-1 drives the complaint filing and real-time tracking flow; PS-2 drives the officer dashboard for complaint management; PS-3 drives the admin oversight and reporting dashboard. Together, these ensure the MERN-based application addresses real, emotionally-grounded needs for every stakeholder rather than being built around assumptions.